

INTAKE 28 WELFARE SCHEME (I28WS)

CONSTITUTION

(Revised Edition – Version 2.0)

A Voluntary, Non-Profit and Non-Political Welfare Association for Interested Officers of Intake 28 of the Ghana Immigration Service.

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ARTICLE 1 – NAME OF THE SCHEME

The name of the welfare organization shall be known as the **Intake 28 Welfare Scheme (I28WS)**.

The Scheme is established as a voluntary, non-profit and non-political welfare association for interested officers of Intake 28 of the Ghana Immigration Service. The Scheme shall operate solely for the welfare, mutual support and collective interest of its members in accordance with this Constitution.

ARTICLE 2 – PREAMBLE

We, the interested members of **Intake 28** of the Ghana Immigration Service, recognizing the importance of unity, solidarity, mutual support, transparency, accountability and collective responsibility, hereby adopt this Constitution as the supreme governing document of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme.

We acknowledge that every member may, at one time or another, experience significant life events, emergencies or unforeseen circumstances requiring financial, emotional or moral support.

We therefore voluntarily agree to contribute towards a common **Welfare Fund** for the mutual benefit of members in accordance with the provisions of this Constitution.

We further commit ourselves to administering the Scheme fairly, honestly, responsibly and transparently through a clearly defined governance structure and the officially approved Welfare Portal, thereby ensuring accountability, proper record keeping, and equal treatment of members and the long-term sustainability of the Welfare Scheme.

We affirm that this Constitution shall guide the administration, governance and development of the Scheme and shall be binding on every member upon admission.

ARTICLE 3 – INTERPRETATION AND DEFINITIONS

Unless the context otherwise requires, the following words and expressions shall have the meanings assigned to them in this Constitution.

Active Member

A member who:

- Has been duly admitted into the Scheme;
- Has successfully activated his or her Welfare Portal account;
- Pays approved monthly contributions;
- Complies with this Constitution; and
- Is not under suspension or any disciplinary restriction affecting membership status.

Benefit Eligibility

The percentage of the applicable maximum welfare benefit that a member qualifies to receive under the approved Welfare Benefit Eligibility Formula.

Executive Committee

The elected governing body responsible for the day-to-day administration, management and implementation of this Constitution on behalf of the General Assembly.

Founding Member

A member who contributed the approved one-time Portal Development Contribution before the official commencement of the Welfare Scheme and whose name appears in the Founding Members Register.

General Assembly

The supreme decision-making body of the Scheme comprising all Active Members.

Membership Maturity

The status attained by a member upon successfully completing six (6) continuous months of Active Membership and accumulating six (6) Welfare Points, thereby becoming eligible for welfare benefits under this Constitution.

Welfare Benefit

Financial assistance payable to an eligible member following the occurrence of an approved welfare event, subject to this Constitution.

Welfare Fund

The common pool of funds established through member contributions and any other approved sources for the administration of the Scheme and payment of welfare benefits.

Welfare Points

Points earned through successful monthly contributions in accordance with this Constitution. Welfare Points shall form part of the **Welfare Benefit Eligibility Formula** administered through the Welfare Portal.

Welfare Portal

The officially approved electronic platform of the Scheme responsible for member registration, account activation, contribution management, Welfare Points, benefit eligibility calculations, welfare applications, receipts, financial records, notifications, audit records and other official records of the Scheme.

The Welfare Portal shall serve as the official electronic records management system of the Scheme, subject to any contingency arrangements approved under this Constitution.

Continuous Active Membership

The uninterrupted period during which a member remains an Active Member and continues to satisfy all membership obligations under this Constitution.

Welfare Event

Any event approved under this Constitution for which an eligible member may apply for welfare assistance.

General Interpretation

Unless the context otherwise requires:

Words importing the singular shall include the plural, and vice versa.

Words importing one gender shall include every gender.

References to any Article or Schedule shall mean the corresponding Article or Schedule of this Constitution unless otherwise stated.

Headings and titles are inserted for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of this Constitution.

Where any provision of this Constitution is capable of more than one interpretation, the interpretation that best promotes fairness, transparency, accountability, equality, sustainability and the objectives of the Welfare Scheme shall prevail.

ARTICLE 4 – AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

The objectives of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme shall be to:

1. Promote unity, friendship, cooperation and solidarity among interested officers of Intake 28 of the Ghana Immigration Service.
2. Establish and maintain a sustainable Welfare Fund through regular member contributions and prudent financial management.
3. Provide financial assistance to eligible members during approved welfare events in accordance with this Constitution.
4. Encourage responsibility, commitment, consistency and active participation among members.
5. Promote transparency, accountability, integrity, fairness and equality in the administration of the Welfare Scheme.
6. Protect the long-term sustainability of the Welfare Fund for both present and future members.
7. Maintain accurate financial, administrative and membership records through the officially approved Welfare Portal and any approved contingency arrangements.
8. Promote responsible governance through democratic decision-making, accountability and effective leadership.
9. Foster mutual care, compassion and a sense of belonging among all members.
10. Promote the continuous development and improvement of the Welfare Scheme in the best interest of all members.

ARTICLE 5 – MEMBERSHIP

Section 1 – Eligibility

- Membership shall be open to all interested officers of Intake 28 of the Ghana Immigration Service.
- Membership shall be voluntary and shall not be compulsory.
- Every applicant shall complete the prescribed registration process through the officially approved Welfare Portal or by any other method approved by the Executive Committee.
- Membership shall become effective only after approval by the Executive Committee and successful activation of the applicant's Welfare Portal account.

Section 2 – Active Membership

A member shall be regarded as an Active Member only if he or she:

- Is duly registered with the Scheme;
- Has successfully activated his or her Welfare Portal account;
- Pays approved monthly contributions;
- Complies with this Constitution; and
- Is not under suspension.

Section 3 – Responsibilities of Members

Every member shall:

- Pay approved monthly contributions promptly;
- Provide complete and accurate personal information;
- Promptly update personal information whenever necessary;
- Cooperate with verification processes where required;
- Protect the confidentiality of his or her Welfare Portal account;
- Comply with this Constitution;
- Respect decisions lawfully made under this Constitution; and
- Uphold the integrity, unity and reputation of the Welfare Scheme.

Section 4 – Registration and Portal Development Contribution

Prior to the official commencement of the Welfare Scheme, every Founding Member made a one-time Portal Development Contribution of GH¢20.00 (Twenty Ghana Cedis) towards the establishment of the official Welfare Portal.

Upon the official commencement of the Welfare Scheme, every person applying for membership thereafter shall pay a one-time Registration and Portal Development Fee as may be approved by the General Assembly.

The Registration and Portal Development Fee shall be separate from the monthly welfare contribution and shall be used to support member registration, system administration, maintenance, security, hosting, upgrades and other approved purposes relating to the Welfare Portal.

The Registration and Portal Development Fee shall be payable only once and shall not be refundable upon resignation, withdrawal, suspension or termination of membership.

ARTICLE 6 – GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Section 1 – Status

The General Assembly shall be the supreme decision-making body of the Welfare Scheme.

Its decisions, when made in accordance with this Constitution, shall be binding on every member.

Section 2 – Composition

The General Assembly shall consist of all Active Members of the Scheme.

Every Active Member shall have the right to:

- Attend meetings;
- Participate in deliberations;
- Vote on matters requiring the decision of members; and
- Contest for any elective office for which he or she qualifies under this Constitution.

Section 3 – Meetings

The General Assembly shall hold an Annual General Meeting (AGM) once every calendar year.

An Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) may be convened:

- By the Executive Committee; or
- Upon a written request by not less than twenty-five percent (25%) of Active Members stating the purpose of the meeting.

Section 4 – Notice of Meetings

Notice of every General Assembly meeting shall be communicated to members at least fourteen (14) days before the meeting through the Welfare Portal or any other approved communication channel.

Where circumstances require urgent action, an Extraordinary General Meeting may be convened upon shorter notice, provided the reason for the urgency is communicated to members.

Section 5 – Quorum

One-third (1/3) of Active Members shall constitute a quorum for meetings of the General Assembly.

Where quorum is not attained within thirty (30) minutes of the scheduled commencement of the meeting, the meeting shall be adjourned and reconvened on a date determined by the Executive Committee, with reasonable notice given to members.

Section 6 – Voting

Every Active Member present at a General Assembly meeting shall have one vote. Except where otherwise provided in this Constitution, decisions shall be made by a simple majority of members present and voting.

Voting may be conducted by secret ballot, show of hands or any other method approved by the General Assembly.

Proxy voting shall not be permitted unless expressly authorized by an amendment to this Constitution.

Section 7 – Powers of the General Assembly

The General Assembly shall have authority to:

- Elect and remove members of the Executive Committee;
- Approve amendments to this Constitution;
- Approve the annual budget and receive financial reports;
- Determine the amount of monthly contributions and registration fees;
- Approve major policy decisions affecting the Scheme;
- Consider appeals submitted under this Constitution;
- Approve the dissolution of the Scheme in accordance with this Constitution;
- Exercise any other authority reserved to it under this Constitution.

ARTICLE 7 – EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

Section 1 – Status

The Executive Committee shall be the principal administrative body of the Welfare Scheme and shall be responsible for implementing the decisions of the General Assembly and administering the day-to-day affairs of the Scheme.

The Executive Committee shall at all times act in the best interest of the Welfare Scheme and its members.

Section 2 – Composition

The Executive Committee shall consist of:

- President
- Vice President
- Secretary
- Assistant Secretary
- Treasurer
- Financial Secretary
- Organizing Secretary
- Welfare and Public Relations Officer

The General Assembly may create, merge or abolish offices whenever necessary for the effective administration of the Scheme.

The responsibilities of each office shall be set out in Schedule B of this Constitution.

Section 3 – Eligibility for Office

A person shall qualify for election to the Executive Committee only if him or her:

- Is an Active Member;
- Has attained Membership Maturity;
- Is not under suspension or disciplinary sanction; and
- Is not in arrears of approved monthly contributions at the time of nomination.

Section 4 – Election

Members of the Executive Committee shall be elected by the General Assembly.

The election process shall be conducted in a fair, transparent and democratic manner.

Where more than one candidate contests an office, voting shall be by secret ballot unless the General Assembly unanimously decides otherwise.

Section 5 – Term of Office

A member who has served two (2) consecutive terms in the same office may, where the General Assembly is satisfied with the member's performance and leadership, be nominated and elected to serve additional consecutive terms in the same office.

Nothing in this Constitution shall prevent any member from contesting a different office for which he or she is qualified under this Constitution.

Every election or re-election shall be conducted in accordance with the democratic principles and procedures established under this Constitution.

Section 6 – Meetings

The Executive Committee shall meet as often as necessary for the effective administration of the Scheme and shall hold not fewer than four (4) meetings in every calendar year.

The Secretary shall keep accurate minutes of every meeting.

Section 7 – Vacancy

Where a vacancy occurs before the expiration of an officer's term, the Executive Committee may appoint an Acting Officer until the vacancy is filled in accordance with procedures approved by the General Assembly.

Section 8 – Removal from Office

An Executive Committee member may be removed from office by the General Assembly upon:

- Misconduct;
- Abuse of office;
- Gross negligence;
- Persistent failure to perform official duties;
- Loss of eligibility under this Constitution; or
- Any other conduct considered prejudicial to the Welfare Scheme.

The affected officer shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is taken.

Section 9 – Conflict of Interest

No member of the Executive Committee shall participate in the verification, deliberation or approval of any matter in which that member has a personal or financial interest.

Where such a conflict exists, the member shall disclose the conflict and withdraw from all discussions and decisions relating to the matter.

The remaining members of the Executive Committee shall determine the matter in accordance with this Constitution.

ARTICLE 8 – WELFARE PORTAL

Section 1 – Establishment

The Welfare Scheme shall establish and maintain an official electronic Welfare Portal for the efficient administration of the Scheme.

The official Welfare Portal was established through a collective development fund of **GH¢3,000.00 (Three Thousand Ghana Cedis)**, raised from the one-time Portal Development Contributions made by the Founding Members of the Welfare Scheme, for its design, development, deployment and implementation.

In furtherance of establishing the Scheme as a legally recognized association, members also collectively approved and contributed an additional sum of **GH¢1,800.00 (One Thousand Eight Hundred Ghana Cedis)** towards the registration of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme with the Registrar of Companies of Ghana (formerly the Registrar-General's Department).

The Welfare Portal and the legal registration of the Scheme represent foundational assets established through the collective contributions of members and shall remain the collective property of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme.

The Welfare Portal shall serve as the official digital platform for the administration of the Welfare Scheme and shall facilitate member registration, account activation, contribution management, welfare administration, financial reporting, record keeping and such other functions as may be approved under this Constitution.

Section 2 – Purpose of the Welfare Portal

The Welfare Portal shall, among other functions, facilitate:

- Member registration;
- Account activation;
- Profile management;
- Monthly contribution payments;
- Payment history and receipts;

- Welfare applications;
- Welfare-Points management;
- Benefit Eligibility calculations;
- Financial reporting;
- Member notifications;
- Audit records;
- Any other function approved by the Executive Committee or General Assembly for the efficient administration of the Scheme.

Section 3 – Official Records

The Welfare Portal shall constitute the official electronic records management system of the Welfare Scheme.

Subject to any approved contingency arrangements, all membership records, financial records, payment histories, Welfare Points, applications and administrative records maintained through the Welfare Portal shall be regarded as the official records of the Scheme.

Section 4 – Ownership

The Welfare Portal, together with all records, databases and information maintained through it, shall remain the collective property of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme. No individual member, Executive Officer, developer, consultant or service provider shall acquire ownership of the Welfare Portal or the information maintained on behalf of the Scheme.

Section 5 – Administration

The Executive Committee shall be responsible for the oversight, administration and security of the Welfare Portal.

The Executive Committee may appoint qualified technical service providers to develop, maintain, secure or improve the Welfare Portal where necessary.

Such appointments shall not affect the ownership of the Welfare Portal by the Welfare Scheme.

Section 6 – Portal Continuity

Where the Welfare Portal becomes temporarily unavailable due to technical failure, maintenance or any unforeseen circumstance, the Executive Committee shall

implement approved contingency measures to ensure the uninterrupted administration of the Scheme.

All records generated during such periods shall be entered into the Welfare Portal immediately after normal operations are restored.

Section 7 – Data Protection

The Executive Committee shall take reasonable measures to safeguard the confidentiality, integrity and security of member information maintained by the Welfare Scheme.

Access to confidential records shall be limited to persons authorized to perform official duties under this Constitution.

ARTICLE 9 – CONTRIBUTIONS AND THE WELFARE FUND

Section 1 – Monthly Contributions

Every Active Member shall pay the monthly contribution approved by the General Assembly.

The amount of the monthly contribution may be reviewed from time to time in accordance with this Constitution.

Monthly contributions shall be paid through the officially approved Welfare Portal or any other payment method approved by the Executive Committee.

Section 2 – Nature of Contributions

Monthly contributions shall form part of a common Welfare Fund established for the collective benefit of members.

Accordingly:

- Monthly contributions are not personal savings.
- Monthly contributions are not investments.
- Monthly contributions do not create personal ownership of the Welfare Fund.
- Contributions shall not be refundable except where expressly provided under this Constitution.

Section 3 – Welfare Fund

The Welfare Fund shall be used solely for purposes approved under this Constitution, including:

- Payment of approved welfare benefits;
- Administration of the Welfare Scheme;
- Maintenance and improvement of the Welfare Portal;
- Approved operational expenses; and
- Any other expenditure authorized by the General Assembly.

Under no circumstance shall any person use the Welfare Fund for personal benefit or unauthorized purposes.

Section 4 – Review of Contributions

The General Assembly may review the monthly contribution whenever necessary to ensure the sustainability of the Welfare Scheme.

Any change in the monthly contribution shall require the approval of not less than two-thirds (2/3) of Active Members present and voting at a duly constituted meeting.

Section 5 – Financial Records

Every contribution received by the Scheme shall be properly recorded.

The Welfare Portal shall maintain, where applicable:

- Payment records;
- Electronic receipts;
- Contribution history;
- Audit records; and
- Other financial records necessary for the administration of the Scheme.

Section 6 – Contribution Default

Every Active Member shall make monthly contributions on or before the approved due date.

A member who fails to pay monthly contributions for two (2) consecutive months before attaining six (6) continuous months of active membership shall have his or her Membership Maturity and Welfare Points automatically reset to zero and shall recommence the qualifying period.

A member who defaults for **two (2) consecutive months** after attaining Membership Maturity shall be classified as an Inactive (Defaulting) Member.

An Inactive (Defaulting) Member shall:

- Be ineligible to receive welfare benefits;
- Cease to earn additional Welfare Points;
- Cease to progress to higher maturity levels until all outstanding contributions are settled.

Upon regularizing all outstanding contributions and resuming monthly payments, the member's Active Membership Status, Welfare Points and Membership Maturity shall be restored, and progression shall continue from where it was suspended.

A member who remains in continuous default for **six (6) consecutive months** shall be deemed to have lapsed membership and shall be required to apply for re-admission under **Article 16**.

A member who fails to pay a monthly contribution shall incur an outstanding contribution (arrears) for that month. Payment of subsequent monthly contributions shall not automatically clear the arrears.

A member may continue making current monthly contributions, but all outstanding arrears shall remain payable. Members with outstanding arrears shall not qualify for welfare benefit payments until all arrears have been fully settled, unless otherwise approved by the Executive Committee under exceptional circumstances.

ARTICLE 10 – FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

Section 1 – Custody of Funds

All monies belonging to the Welfare Scheme shall be kept in an official bank account or any other secure financial institution approved by the General Assembly. The Welfare Fund shall not be kept in the personal account of any member or Executive Officer.

Section 2 – Signatories

The General Assembly shall determine the authorized signatories to the official accounts of the Welfare Scheme.

No single person shall exercise exclusive control over the withdrawal or disbursement of Scheme funds.

Appropriate internal controls shall be maintained to protect the assets of the Welfare Scheme.

Section 3 – Budget

The Executive Committee shall prepare an annual budget for the administration of the Welfare Scheme.

The budget shall be presented to the General Assembly for consideration and approval.

Section 4 – Financial Reporting

The Treasurer, in collaboration with the Financial Secretary, shall prepare periodic financial reports for presentation to the General Assembly.

Such reports shall include:

- Income received;
- Welfare benefits paid;
- Administrative expenditure;
- Account balances;
- Outstanding obligations; and
- Any other information reasonably required by members.

Section 5 – Audit

The financial records of the Welfare Scheme shall be examined periodically by an independent auditor or by auditors appointed by the General Assembly.

The audit report shall be presented to members at the Annual General Meeting or at any other meeting determined by the General Assembly.

Section 6 – Accountability

Every Executive Officer entrusted with Scheme funds or property shall be accountable to the General Assembly.

Any person who misappropriates, improperly authorizes or unlawfully uses Scheme funds or property shall be subject to disciplinary action and any other lawful measures considered necessary by the General Assembly.

Section 7 – Financial Sustainability

The Executive Committee shall manage the Welfare Fund responsibly to ensure the continued ability of the Scheme to meet its obligations to both present and future members.

In administering the Welfare Fund, the Executive Committee shall exercise prudence, fairness and accountability, taking into account the long-term sustainability of the Scheme.

ARTICLE 11 – WELFARE BENEFITS

Section 1 – Purpose

The Welfare Scheme shall provide financial assistance to eligible members upon the occurrence of approved welfare events in accordance with this Constitution.

The payment of welfare benefits shall be guided by fairness, transparency, consistency and the long-term sustainability of the Welfare Fund.

Section 2 – Approved Welfare Events

Subject to this Constitution, welfare benefits may be granted for the following events:

- Marriage;
- Childbirth;
- Serious illness / Hospitalization;
- Medical emergency;
- Death of an Active Member;
- Death of a Spouse;
- Death of a Parent; and
- Any other welfare event approved by the General Assembly.

Section 3 – Maximum Benefit Ceilings

The maximum welfare benefit payable for each approved welfare event shall be determined by the General Assembly and recorded in Schedule A, which may be amended from time to time without requiring any amendment to the substantive provisions of this Constitution.

The maximum benefit ceilings may be reviewed whenever necessary to ensure the sustainability of the Welfare Scheme.

No member shall automatically be entitled to the full maximum benefit.

The actual amount payable shall be determined in accordance with the Welfare Benefit Eligibility provisions of this Constitution.

Section 4 – Verification

Every welfare application shall be verified before approval.

The Executive Committee may request any information or supporting documents reasonably required to establish the validity of a claim.

Any member who knowingly submits false or misleading information shall be subject to disciplinary action under this Constitution.

Section 5 – Payment of Benefits

Approved welfare benefits shall be paid within a reasonable period after completion of the verification and approval process, subject to the financial capacity of the Welfare Fund.

ARTICLE 12 – MAXIMUM BENEFITS CEILING TABLE

The Welfare Scheme shall provide financial assistance to eligible members during approved welfare events.

The maximum benefit ceilings shall be as follows:

Welfare Event	Maximum Benefit
Marriage	GH¢15,000
Childbirth	GH¢5,000
Serious Illness / Medical Emergency	GH¢20,000
Death of Active Member	GH¢20,000
Death of Spouse	GH¢15,000
Death of Father or Mother	GH¢15,000 (where only one parent is alive). Where both parents are alive, the maximum benefit shall be GH¢10,000 per parent, payable once upon the death of each parent.

The above amounts represent the **maximum benefit ceilings** and shall not automatically be payable in full.

The actual amount payable shall be determined using the Welfare Benefit Formula provided under this Constitution.

The Executive Committee shall verify every welfare application before approval.

ARTICLE 13 – WELFARE POINTS AND BENEFIT ELIGIBILITY

Section 1 – Welfare Points

The Welfare Scheme shall operate a Welfare Points System through the officially approved Welfare Portal.

Every successful monthly contribution shall earn **one (1) Welfare Point**.

Welfare Points shall:

- Accumulate throughout Active Membership;
- Be calculated automatically by the Welfare Portal;
- Not be transferable between members; and
- Form part of the Welfare Benefit Eligibility process established under this Constitution.

Unless otherwise approved by the General Assembly, Special Contributions shall not earn Welfare Points.

Section 2 – Membership Maturity

A member shall attain **Membership Maturity** upon:

- Completing six (6) continuous months of Active Membership; and
- Accumulating six (6) Welfare Points.

Upon attaining Membership Maturity, the member shall become eligible to receive welfare benefits under this Constitution.

Section 3 – Benefit Eligibility

Upon attaining Membership Maturity, a member shall immediately become eligible for **twenty-five percent (25%)** of the applicable maximum welfare benefit.

The remaining Benefit Eligibility shall be progressively earned through continued Active Membership and successful monthly contributions until the member attains full Benefit Eligibility.

The Welfare Portal shall automatically calculate and display each member's applicable Benefit Eligibility in accordance with this Constitution.

Section 4 – Membership Progression

Membership progression shall be as follows:

Continuous Active Membership	Welfare Points	Benefit Eligibility
1–5 Months	1–5	Not Eligible
6 Months (Membership Maturity)	6	25%
Each additional successful monthly contribution	+1	Progressively Increases
36 Months	36	100%

Section 5 – Suspension of Progression

Where a member ceases to qualify as an Active Member due to default in monthly contributions or any other reason provided under this Constitution, the member shall cease to earn additional Welfare Points and Benefit Eligibility shall not continue to increase until Active Membership is restored.

Section 6 – Constitutional Principle

The Welfare Scheme shall determine Benefit Eligibility through the Membership Maturity and Welfare Points framework established under this Constitution.

The Welfare Portal shall automatically calculate the applicable Benefit Eligibility for every eligible member.

Section 7 – Benefit Eligibility Formula

Benefit Eligibility shall be determined in accordance with the following principles: Membership Maturity shall be attained after six (6) continuous months of Active Membership and six (6) Welfare Points.

Upon attaining Membership Maturity, Benefit Eligibility shall commence at **twenty-five percent (25%)** of the applicable maximum welfare benefit.

The remaining seventy-five percent (75%) of Benefit Eligibility shall be progressively earned over the succeeding thirty (30) continuous months of continuous Active Membership.

Every additional successful monthly contribution shall earn **one (1) Welfare Point** and shall progressively increase Benefit Eligibility.

Maximum Benefit Eligibility of one hundred percent **(100%)** shall be attained after **thirty-six (36)** continuous months of Active Membership and **thirty-six (36)** Welfare Points.

Section 8 – Welfare Portal Authority

The Welfare Portal shall serve as the official system for calculating Benefit Eligibility under this Constitution.

The Portal shall calculate and display:

Welfare Points;

- Membership Maturity Status;
- Continuous Active Membership;
- Benefit Eligibility Percentage; and
- Such other information approved by the Executive Committee for the administration of the Scheme.

No Executive Officer shall arbitrarily alter the Benefit Eligibility calculated by the Welfare Portal except where a correction is required to rectify an administrative error, and every such correction shall be properly documented.

Section 9 – Sustainability Principle

In administering welfare benefits, the Executive Committee shall ensure that the Welfare Fund remains capable of meeting both present and future obligations of the Scheme.

Where exceptional financial circumstances arise, the General Assembly may approve temporary measures necessary to preserve the sustainability of the Welfare Fund.

ARTICLE 14 – BENEFICIARY NOMINATION

Section 1 – Nomination

Every member shall nominate a beneficiary or beneficiaries through the Welfare Portal or by any other method approved by the Executive Committee.
Members shall ensure that beneficiary information remains accurate and up to date.

Section 2 – Amendment of Nomination

A member may amend or replace his or her nominated beneficiary at any time.
The most recent valid nomination recorded by the Scheme shall prevail.

Section 3 – Verification

The Executive Committee may verify beneficiary information whenever necessary before approving any claim.

Section 4 – Effect of Nomination

A beneficiary nomination shall assist the Welfare Scheme in determining the appropriate recipient of benefits payable under this Constitution.

Before any benefit is paid, the Executive Committee may require reasonable proof of the identity and entitlement of the nominated beneficiary.

Where no valid nomination exists, the Executive Committee shall determine the appropriate beneficiary in accordance with this Constitution and any applicable laws.

ARTICLE 15 – DISCIPLINE AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

Section 1 – Conduct of Members

Every member shall conduct himself or herself in a manner that promotes the unity, integrity, dignity and good reputation of the Welfare Scheme.

Every member shall:

- Comply with this Constitution;
- Cooperate with the Executive Committee in the lawful administration of the Scheme;
- Provide truthful information at all times;
- Respect decisions lawfully made under this Constitution; and
- Refrain from any conduct that may bring the Welfare Scheme into disrepute.

Section 2 – Misconduct

A member commits misconduct where he or she:

- Knowingly provides false or misleading information;
- Submits a fraudulent welfare application;
- Attempts to manipulate Welfare Points, Benefit Eligibility or financial records;
- Tampers with Welfare Portal records;
- Misappropriates Scheme funds or property;
- Impersonates another member or unlawfully accesses the Welfare Portal;
- Deliberately misuses Scheme resources; or
- Engages in conduct prejudicial to the Welfare Scheme.

Section 3 – Disciplinary Measures

Subject to the principles of fairness and natural justice, the Executive Committee may impose one or more of the following disciplinary measures:

- Verbal Warning;
- Written Warning;
- Suspension of Welfare Benefits or other membership privileges
- Suspension of Membership;
- Restitution or repayment of improperly obtained benefits;
- Removal from office where applicable; or
- Expulsion from the Welfare Scheme.

No disciplinary action shall be taken unless the affected member has first been informed of the allegations and given a reasonable opportunity to respond.

Section 4 – Dispute Resolution

Any dispute arising under this Constitution shall first be referred to the Executive Committee for resolution.

Where the dispute is not resolved, the matter shall be referred to the General Assembly, whose decision shall be final unless otherwise determined by applicable law.

ARTICLE 16 – WITHDRAWAL, SUSPENSION AND RE-ADMISSION

Section 1 – Voluntary Withdrawal

A member may voluntarily withdraw from the Welfare Scheme by giving written notice to the Executive Committee.

Withdrawal shall become effective upon acknowledgment by the Executive Committee.

Section 2 – Effect of Withdrawal

Upon withdrawal:

- Membership shall cease;
- Welfare Benefits shall cease;
- Welfare Points shall become inactive;
- Access to member services within the Welfare Portal shall cease, except where historical records remain accessible in accordance with Scheme policy.

Section 3 – Contributions upon Withdrawal

Monthly contributions paid into the Welfare Fund shall not be refundable.

The Welfare Scheme is a mutual support arrangement and shall not operate as a savings, investment or loan scheme.

Section 4 – Re-admission

A former member may apply for re-admission.

Where approved:

The applicant shall satisfy any conditions determined by the Executive Committee;

Membership Maturity shall recommence;

The accumulation of Welfare Points shall recommence from the date of re-admission unless otherwise determined by the General Assembly under exceptional circumstances.

Section 5 – Suspension

The Executive Committee may suspend a member for misconduct or persistent violation of this Constitution.

During suspension:

- Welfare Benefits shall remain suspended;
- Welfare Points shall not accumulate; and
- The member shall continue to comply with any obligations determined under this Constitution.

ARTICLE 17 – AMENDMENT OF THE CONSTITUTION

This Constitution may be amended whenever necessary to improve the governance, administration or sustainability of the Welfare Scheme.

Every proposed amendment shall:

- Be submitted in writing;
- Clearly state the provisions proposed for amendment;
- Be circulated to members before deliberation;
- Be discussed at a duly constituted meeting of the General Assembly; and
- Be approved by not less than two-thirds (2/3) of Active Members present and voting.
- No amendment shall take effect until duly approved by the General Assembly.

ARTICLE 18 – DISSOLUTION OF THE SCHEME

The Welfare Scheme shall only be dissolved upon the approval of not less than three-quarters (3/4) of all Active Members.

Upon dissolution:

- All liabilities shall first be settled;
- All remaining assets shall be distributed in accordance with a resolution of the General Assembly;
- The Welfare Portal and all official records shall be securely archived; and
- Confidential member information shall continue to be protected in accordance with applicable law.

ARTICLE 19 – GENERAL PROVISIONS

This Constitution shall be the supreme governing document of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme.

Every member shall be bound by this Constitution upon admission into the Scheme.

The Welfare Portal shall serve as the official digital platform for maintaining membership records, Welfare Points, contribution history, receipts, welfare applications, financial records, notifications, audit logs and other official records of the Scheme.

Official communication may be made through the Welfare Portal, SMS, email or any other communication platform approved by the Executive Committee.

Any matter not expressly provided for in this Constitution shall be determined by the Executive Committee, subject to ratification by the General Assembly where required under this Constitution.

Where any provision of this Constitution conflicts with a mandatory provision of the laws of the Republic of Ghana, the applicable law shall prevail to the extent of the inconsistency, and the remaining provisions of this Constitution shall continue in full force and effect.

SCHEDULE A – WELFARE BENEFIT & ELIGIBILITY FRAMEWORK

Maximum Welfare Benefit Ceilings

The maximum welfare benefit payable for each approved welfare event shall be as approved by the General Assembly from time to time.

The approved benefit ceilings shall form part of this Schedule and may be reviewed by resolution of the General Assembly without requiring an amendment to the substantive provisions of this Constitution.

The maximum benefit ceilings shall be as follows:

Welfare Event	Maximum Benefit
Marriage	GH¢15,000
Childbirth	GH¢5,000
Serious Illness / Medical Emergency	GH¢20,000
Death of Active Member	GH¢20,000
Death of Spouse	GH¢15,000
Death of Father or Mother	GH¢15,000 (where only one parent is alive). Where both parents are alive, the maximum benefit shall be GH¢10,000 per parent, payable once upon the death of each parent.

The Welfare Benefit Eligibility Framework shall be administered through the officially approved Welfare Portal in accordance with this Constitution.

Continuous Active Membership	Welfare Points	Benefit Eligibility
1-5 Months	1-5	Not Eligible
6 Months (Membership Maturity)	6	25%
Each additional successful monthly contribution	+1	Progressively Increases Benefit Eligibility
36 Months	36	100%

Benefit Eligibility Framework

The Welfare Portal shall automatically calculate and display:

- Welfare Points;
- Membership Maturity Status;
- Continuous Active Membership;
- Benefit Eligibility Percentage; and
- Any other information approved by the Executive Committee for the administration of the Scheme.

Illustrative Examples (For Guidance Only)

The following examples are provided solely to illustrate the application of the Welfare Benefit Eligibility Formula under this Constitution. The officially approved Welfare Portal shall remain the authoritative system for calculating and displaying every member's Benefit Eligibility.

Continuous Active Membership	Welfare Points	Benefit Eligibility (Displayed)
1 Month	1	Not Eligible
2 Months	2	Not Eligible
3 Months	3	Not Eligible
4 Months	4	Not Eligible
5 Months	5	Not Eligible
6 Months (Membership Maturity)	6	25%
7 Months	7	27%
8 Months	8	30%
9 Months	9	32%
10 Months	10	35%
11 Months	11	37%
12 Months	12	40%
18 Months	18	55%

Continuous Active Membership Welfare Points Benefit Eligibility (Displayed)

24 Months	24	70%
30 Months	30	85%
36 Months	36	100%

Example 1 – Marriage Benefit

Assume the maximum welfare benefit approved for marriage is GH¢15,000.00.

A member who has completed 6 months of Active Membership and has 6 Welfare Points shall be eligible for 25%, which is GH¢3,750.00.

A member who has completed 12 months of Active Membership and has 12 Welfare Points shall have a displayed Benefit Eligibility of 40%, which is GH¢6,000.00.

A member who has completed 36 months of Active Membership and has 36 Welfare Points shall be eligible for 100%, which is GH¢15,000.00.

Example 2 – Death Benefit

Assume the maximum welfare benefit approved for the death of an Active Member is GH¢20,000.00.

A member with 25% Benefit Eligibility shall qualify for GH¢5,000.00.

A member with 70% Benefit Eligibility shall qualify for GH¢14,000.00.

A member with 100% Benefit Eligibility shall qualify for GH¢20,000.00.

Important Note

The Benefit Eligibility percentages shown above are illustrative. The officially approved Welfare Portal shall automatically calculate and display the applicable Benefit Eligibility percentage for every member in accordance with the Welfare Benefit Eligibility Formula established under this Constitution.

SCHEDULE B – EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE OFFICES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

The Executive Committee shall comprise the following offices:

President - Provides leadership to the Welfare Scheme, presides over meetings and ensures the implementation of decisions of the General Assembly and Executive Committee.

Vice President - Assists the President and performs the functions of the President whenever the President is absent or unable to act.

Secretary - Keeps the official records of the Scheme, prepares notices, minutes and correspondence and maintains official documentation.

Assistant Secretary - Assists the Secretary and performs the Secretary's functions in his or her absence.

Treasurer - Has custody of the Welfare Fund, keeps proper financial records and presents financial statements as required.

Financial Secretary - Maintains contribution records, monitors payments and assists in the financial administration of the Scheme.

Organizing Secretary - Coordinates meetings, programs and other activities approved by the Executive Committee.

Welfare and Public Relations Officer - Coordinates welfare activities, member engagement and public communication on behalf of the Scheme.

The principal responsibilities of the respective offices shall be prescribed by the General Assembly and may be reviewed from time to time, provided such review does not conflict with this Constitution.

SCHEDULE C – FOUNDING MEMBERS REGISTER

The Executive Committee shall maintain an official register of all Founding Members of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme.

The Register shall contain such particulars as may be approved by the Executive Committee and shall form part of the permanent historical records of the Scheme.

CERTIFICATION

We, the undersigned Executive Committee Members of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme, hereby certify that this Constitution was duly reviewed, considered and adopted by the General Assembly of the Intake 28 Welfare Scheme.

This Constitution shall take effect from the date of its approval and shall remain the supreme governing document of the Scheme until amended or replaced in accordance with its provisions.

THE EXECUTIVES COMMITTEE

<u>Position</u>	<u>Name</u>	<u>Signature</u>	<u>Date</u>
1. President			
2. Vice – President			
3. Secretary			
4. Assistant Secretary			
5. Treasurer			
6. Financial Secretary			
7. Organizing Secretary			
8. Welfare and Public Relations Officer			